

aiSTROM instructor guide

Dorien Herremans

Version 1.0 | Created September 2026

Use these materials for teaching or facilitating an AI strategy discussion. The core activity is making and connecting implementation decisions, using the overview and seven dimension sheets. Participants do not need to read the longer references first.

[Public guide](#) · [Blank visual toolkit](#) · [Complete procurement example](#)

Learning outcomes

Participants should be able to:

- Frame an opportunity before selecting technology.
- Distinguish assumptions, supporting evidence, gaps and unknowns.
- Identify dependencies between data, people, organisation, technology, value, risk and education.
- Turn an unresolved issue into an action with an owner and date.
- Justify a next decision: explore, pilot, revise, defer or stop.

Preparation

Give each group a blank toolkit and a concrete opportunity. Use a real project with shareable information, or one of the fictional exercises in this guide. Print at A3, or confirm that participants can fill, save and reopen the PDFs. Form groups that combine business, domain and technical perspectives where possible.

Ask participants to state their initial proposed approach before showing the completed example. This makes changes in reasoning easier to discuss and reduces copying. Do not ask them to enter confidential organisational information into public files or unapproved AI services.

A 90-minute session

Time	Activity	Output
0–10 min	Frame the problem, beneficiaries and alternatives.	Opportunity box and initial proposal.
10–20 min	Scan the seven dimensions; select the three most consequential uncertainties.	Priority sheets/cards.
20–45 min	Work through selected cards. Label assumptions and unknowns.	Decisions, strengths, gaps and actions.
45–60 min	Exchange with another group; challenge one unsupported conclusion.	Revised status or evidence request.
60–75 min	Connect findings across dimensions and return to the overview.	Coherent next decision and conditions.
75–90 min	Debrief using the completed example or group comparisons.	Explanation of what changed and why.

For 60 minutes, reduce peer review and focus on two or three dimensions. For a longer workshop, give each dimension a separate round and schedule follow-up investigation. Neither format requires resolving all 42 cards in one sitting.

Facilitation prompts

- What evidence supports this answer, and what are you assuming?
- Would a simpler process or non-AI approach meet the objective?
- If this decision changes, which other sheet must change?
- Is “human review” a named task with time and authority, or just a label?
- What would cause you to revise or stop the proposal?
- What specific action could resolve this unknown, and who owns it?

A card may contain both a strength and a gap. ? Unknown is a useful outcome when evidence is missing. The status controls are not a numerical maturity score. A completed form does not mean the prerequisites are satisfied.

Discuss the procurement example

The **complete example** is fictional and deliberately unfinished as an investigation: every card is filled, but many statuses remain unknown or gaps.

Trace three connections:

1. **Data 1.2** → **Team 2.1/2.6** → **KPIs 5.5**: annotation needs expertise, time and a separate evaluation set.
2. **Data 1.4** → **Technology 4.5** → **Risk 6.3**: proprietary inputs may reach providers; training use, retention and access affect deployment choices.
3. **Technology 4.4** → **KPIs 5.3** → **Culture 7.2**: retaining human judgement creates review work and changes roles; automation speed alone is insufficient.

Ask why an initial autonomous-ordering idea became a bounded offline comparison experiment. Alternative conclusions are acceptable if their evidence, trade-offs and conditions are coherent. The example’s thresholds are illustrative choices, not marking criteria.

Feedback criteria

Assess reasoning rather than the number of boxes filled. Look for a clear problem, appropriate alternatives, traceable evidence, meaningful cross-sheet dependencies, specific actions and a defensible next decision. Invite each group to name one uncertainty it could not resolve.

For professional workshops, agree what records may be retained or shared. A redacted decision summary is often more useful than a complete copy of sensitive project data.

Workshop exercises

Version 1.0 · Created September 2026

All scenarios and quantities below are fictional. Their purpose is to expose decisions and dependencies; there is no single required solution.

Exercise A: predict equipment failure

A manufacturer wants to predict failures of production equipment. It has two years of sensor readings, repair notes and downtime records. The records use different machine identifiers, several sensors were replaced during that period, and failure labels are incomplete. Maintenance staff currently inspect machines on a schedule.

The proposed system would flag machines for inspection. Missed failures can interrupt production; false alarms consume maintenance time. There is no agreed baseline for either outcome, and newer machines have little historical data.

Task: frame the opportunity, compare the existing schedule with a prediction-based approach, and prioritise the Data, Technologies and KPIs sheets. Identify who supplies labels, how to separate training and testing over time, what users need to understand, and how much intervention the team can handle. Connect the findings to Team and Culture.

Change to introduce halfway through: the maintenance lead says the team can handle only a few extra inspections per week. Does the proposed metric or threshold still reflect useful performance?

Debrief: look for temporal evaluation, capacity-aware value measures, appropriate uncertainty and preservation of operational expertise. An LLM or an agent is not required.

Exercise B: compare supplier quotations

A procurement team wants an agent to identify replacement components and place orders. Quotations have inconsistent formats and may include confidential pricing. Engineering specifications change over time. The team has experienced buyers but has not evaluated model performance or checked provider data-use terms.

Task: start with the overview, then Data, Technologies and Risk. Extend to Team, Organisation, KPIs and Culture as dependencies emerge. Decide what the system may read, draft, send or change. Consider a simple template as an alternative.

Change to introduce halfway through: a proposed service may use submitted material for model improvement under some account settings. What must be checked before proprietary documents are uploaded? How does this affect hosting and the next experiment?

Debrief: compare with the completed eight-sheet example only after groups have stated their own decision. Discuss differences rather than treating the example as an answer key.

Exercise C: challenge a completed card

Exchange sheets with another group. Select one card marked supported and ask for its evidence. Select one unknown and turn it into a feasible next action. Then identify a decision on another sheet that depends on the answer.

Report one change to the overview. Do not calculate a total score from the status symbols.